

Fermium

100
Fm

The American physicist Albert Ghiorso and his colleagues found fermium in the debris left behind by the first successful hydrogen bomb explosion in 1952, conducted by the USA. This artificial element has no use apart from in research.

ATOMIC MASS (257)

STATE Solid

DISCOVERY 1953 (team led by Albert Ghiorso)

The explosion also produced einsteinium, another element that was unknown at the time.

Mushroom cloud from the 1952 hydrogen bomb test, named "Ivy Mike"



Mendelevium

101
Md

This element is named after the Russian chemist Dmitri Mendeleev, who created the periodic table. It has no commercial uses. Artificial elements such as mendelevium are created in a machine called a particle accelerator. This one can be made by smashing together the atoms of bismuth and argon until they fuse into a single large mendelevium atom.

ATOMIC MASS (258)

STATE Solid

DISCOVERY 1955 (team led by Albert Ghiorso)

Statue of Dmitri Mendeleev in Tobolsk, Russia

